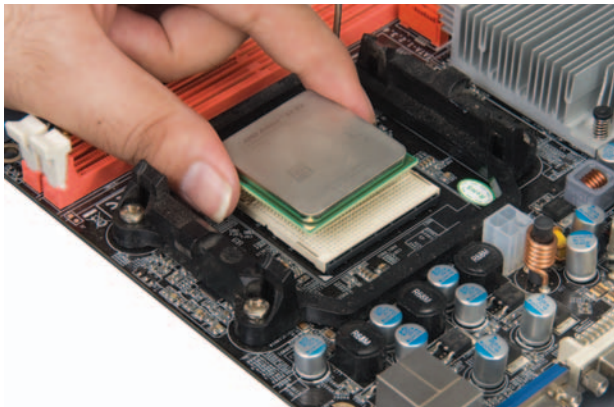


3D TVs

The future of entertainment
is coming ◀ 26

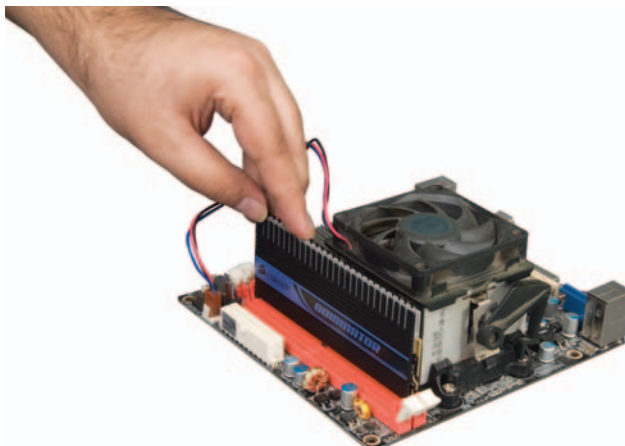
RAM. It can hold up to 8 GB of DDR2-1066 RAM. A good addition for this board is a Wi-Fi kit that is really a bonus and helps you do away with the network cable. This motherboard also comes integrated with the NVIDIA 8200 graphics solution, which can easily play HD video.

- **The processor:** the CPU we used is the AMD 5600X2. We selected this processor to go along with the Zotac 8200 motherboard because of its capability to handle HD playback. Even a low-end processor such as the 5600X2 is sufficient for this purpose.



Installing the AMD Athlon 5600 X2

- **RAM:** since the motherboard has 2 DIMMs, we have used 2 GB of DDR2 - 800 MHz RAM. This is enough for running your operating system and efficiently supporting the processor.



The motherboard with only 2 DIMM Slots

- **The hard drive:** for this HTPC, we used a Seagate Barracuda 7200.11 1.5-TB hard drive. As the cabinet we have selected only has one hard drive bay, and we wanted to get the most out of it. Another plus point to having so much space is you can store huge amounts of data, be it music, movies, TV serials, etc. If you have properly utilised all the space on this drive, the media should last you for months.



Securing the Hard Drive to the cage and then attaching it to the cabinet

- **Optical drive:** we have used an ASUS BC-1205PT Blu-ray drive for our HTPC. This drive comes with 5x BD-ROM, 12x DVD-R, 6x DVD-RW, 4x DVD-R(DL) and 5x DVD-RAM. We used an all-in-one combo drive for our build. Alternatively, you could opt for a DVD writer if you do not wish to purchase Blu-ray discs.



Carefully installing the Asus Blu-ray drive

- **TV tuner card:** unfortunately, the motherboard we have used comes with only one PCIe X1 expansion slot. Therefore, we have opted for an external TV tuner card. We used the Leadtek WinFast PalmTop TV which is a USB external TV-tuner. This looks good and should blend well with the whole setup. If you have a PCI or PCIe TV tuner card with an expansion slot, then it all boils down to the cabinet — whether there is enough space or not.